

Percentage of households using firewood and gas as the main sources of energy for cooking

Comparing the 2012 and 2024 census data, the use of firewood has decreased, and the use of gas has increased in all districts and in all sectors. Compared to other districts, Colombo district (85.5%) shows the highest percentage of households cooking with gas. The highest percentage increase is in the Jaffna district.

Table 11.12 : Percentage of households Using Firewood and gas, by Sector and District, 2024

Sector/ District	Use of firewood		Use of gas	
	2012	2024	2012	2024
Sri Lanka	78.4	55.4	18.5	42.4
Sector				
Urban*	35.8	13.4	53.7	82.1
Rural	86.8	63.1	11.6	35.1
Estate- Rural**	95.0	83.4	3.7	15.3
District				
Colombo	28.8	9.9	60.5	85.5
Gampaha	62.5	31.8	31.0	63.9
Kalutara	77.1	42.4	21.2	55.9
Kandy	80.8	58.3	17.8	40.3
Matale	90.9	75.5	8.4	23.5
Nuwara Eliya	86.5	71.9	11.2	26.6
Galle	83.6	52.1	15.4	46.1
Matara	86.7	61.0	12.6	37.4
Hambantota	93.0	72.4	6.5	26.3
Jaffna	90.7	54.7	5.2	42.3
Mannar	88.5	55.9	8.5	41.1
Vavuniya	83.0	56.5	12.7	41.9
Mullaitivu	97.5	73.8	0.6	24.5
Kilinochchi	96.8	77.3	0.7	21.2
Batticaloa	74.6	42.8	20.3	54.5
Ampara	77.4	48.3	16.5	48.7
Trincomalee	82.4	48.9	13.8	47.9
Kurunegala	94.4	77.2	5.2	21.3
Puttalam	87.4	60.0	10.6	37.3
Anuradhapura	91.9	74.9	7.6	24.0
Polonnaruwa	93.7	77.6	5.7	21.2
Badulla	91.5	80.6	7.7	18.4
Moneragala	96.2	83.6	3.2	15.3
Ratnapura	92.7	78.1	6.7	20.8
Kegalle	92.7	72.9	6.8	26.0

*Although the 2024 census collected information separately as urban and estate urban, here the two categories are combined and shown as urban.

** In the 2012 Census, the sector was identified as “Estate”, whereas in the 2024 Census it is referred to as “Estate Rural”.